

MAJORITY RELIGIONS

Each country is colored according to the religion that is most popular there. In many countries, however, millions of people follow religions that are not the majority religion, and many more are not religious at all.

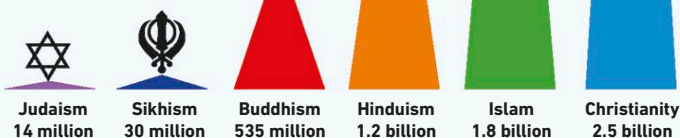
-  Judaism
-  Orthodox Christianity
-  Catholic Christianity
-  Protestant Christianity
-  Sunni Islam
-  Shi'a Islam
-  Hinduism
-  Chinese traditional religion
-  Christianity and native religions
-  Buddhism
-  Shinto

Holy places

A place that religious followers think of as “holy” may be the spiritual center of the religion. It could be the place where it all began, a site of pilgrimage, or the religion’s official headquarters.

Religious followers

Most of the world’s people identify with a religion, whether or not they take part in religious services. Their beliefs, customs, or ancestors link them to their religious community.



JERUSALEM

Contains sites holy to three major world religions.

-  **Western Wall (Judaism)**
Remains of the Temple in Jerusalem, and sacred site of prayer for Jews.
-  **Church of the Holy Sepulchre**
Said by Christians to contain the burial site of Jesus Christ.
-  **Al-Aqsa Mosque (Islam)**
The third-holiest place in Islam, where the Prophet Muhammad is said to have risen to heaven.

NEW FAITHS

New religions have emerged in the last 200 years.

-  **BAHA'I, 1866**
-  **Shrine of the Bab, Haifa**
Resting place of the Bab, revered by the Baha'i faith as a Messenger.
-  **RASTAFARI, 1930**
-  **Jamaica**
Home of Rastafari, whose followers worship Haile Selassie I of Ethiopia as God in human form.
-  **ISKCON, 1966**
-  **New York City**
The International Society for Krishna Consciousness, known as Hare Krishna, began here.

CHRISTIANITY

Followers worship Jesus Christ as the son of God. Christianity is split into these major branches: Orthodox, Catholic, and Protestant.

-  **St. Mary of Zion Church**
Heart of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church, said to hold God's 10 Commandments in the Ark of the Covenant.
-  **The Hand of God, Nigeria**
This megachurch can seat up to 120,000 people within its handlike layout.
-  **Vatican City**
Headquarters of the Roman Catholic Church.
-  **Our Lady of Guadalupe**
Mexico City's famous image of the Virgin Mary and site of a Roman Catholic pilgrimage.